

Royal family ON view

On her travels around the globe, the Queen met world leaders, and while at home she busily carried out a long list of duties.

After the coronation in 1953 came a Commonwealth tour lasting five months. Elizabeth and Philip traveled more than 41,000 miles (66,000 km), visiting countries as large as Australia and as small as Tonga, an island in the South Pacific. With Elizabeth went her wedding dress, which she wore to open

Australia's parliament. She told Australians that she would "not only rule but serve." However, looking happy all the time was hard. She wished she found it as natural as her mother, who was always smiling.

DID YOU KNOW?

On her 1953–54 tour, Elizabeth made 102 speeches and shook hands more than 13,000 times!